REGIONAL, GLOBAL AND MINILATERAL GROUPINGS

CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE → SOUTH ASIAN LAYER READ → WHERE REGIONAL INTEGRATION ACTUALLY → PARTICIPATION TIERS AND WHAT → SOUTHEAST ASIAN ARCHITECTURE AND → OCEANIC AND CONTINENTAL LAYERS

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure: the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

● PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ● APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • active generation g1 • explicit approval of this exact generation is required • all prior artifacts unchanged

00 STAGE 00 — CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE FIVE-LAYER ANSWER

CENTRAL QUESTION AND THE FIVE-LAYER ANSWER · WHY DOES INDIA JOIN SO MANY OVERLAPPING GROUPINGS? · EACH LAYER BUYS A DIFFERENT, NON-IDENTICAL INTEREST · LAYER 1 REGIONAL · MEKONG-GANGA COOPERATION · LAYER 2 TRANS-REGIONAL · LAYER 3 CONTINENTAL · SHANGHAI COOPERATION ORGANISATION

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL QUESTION → why does India join so many overlapping groupings?
- ANSWER → each layer buys a different, non-identical interest
- LAYER 1 REGIONAL → SAARC
- Mekong-Ganga Cooperation

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- LAYER 2 TRANS-REGIONAL → IORA
- LAYER 3 CONTINENTAL → Shanghai Cooperation Organisation
- LAYER 4 GLOBAL GOVERNANCE → Group of Twenty
- LAYER 5 MINILATERAL → Quad

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- RULE → name the layer before analysing the body
- BOUNDARY → Quad maritime security to topic 04; SCO connectivity to topic 05
- Global South to topic 08; UN and Bretton Woods reform linkage to topic 12

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → name the layer before analysing the body.

01 STAGE 01 — SOUTH ASIAN LAYER READ AS A DATED RECORD

SOUTH ASIAN LAYER READ AS A DATED RECORD · 26-27 NOVEMBER 2014 · 18TH SAARC SUMMIT AT KATHMANDU, THE LAST SUMMIT HELD · CHARTER-BASED BODY, 8 MEMBERS PLUS OBSERVERS, STILL IN EXISTENCE · 8 FEBRUARY 2004 · BIMSTEC FREE TRADE AREA FRAMEWORK AGREEMENT; NO FTA CONCLUDED · 30 MARCH 2022 · BIMSTEC CHARTER ADOPTED AT COLOMBO

26-27 NOVEMBER 2014 — 18th SAARC Summit at Kathmandu, the last Summit held → **STATUS — charter-based body, 8 members plus observers, still in existence** → **8 FEBRUARY 2004 — BIMSTEC free trade area framework agreement; no FTA concluded** → **30 MARCH 2022 — BIMSTEC Charter adopted at Colombo** → **20 MAY 2024 — BIMSTEC Charter enters into force; 7 members**

DATED OFFICIAL INSTRUMENT

- 26-27 NOVEMBER 2014 → 18th SAARC Summit at Kathmandu, the last Summit held
- STATUS → charter-based body, 8 members plus observers, still in existence
- 8 FEBRUARY 2004 → BIMSTEC free trade area framework agreement; no FTA concluded

EVIDENTIARY LEVEL IT REACHES

- 30 MARCH 2022 → BIMSTEC Charter adopted at Colombo
- 20 MAY 2024 → BIMSTEC Charter enters into force; 7 members
- 4 APRIL 2025 → 6th BIMSTEC Summit, Bangkok; Bangladesh takes the chair adopts Summit Declaration, Bangkok Vision 2030, Rules of Procedure,

STATUS / CLAIM LIMIT

- Eminent Persons Group report; endorses the 28 March 2025 earthquake statement
- RULE → renamed BIMST-EC and BIMSTEC are one lineage, not two organisations

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → renamed BIMST-EC and BIMSTEC are one lineage, not two organisations.

02 STAGE 02 — WHERE REGIONAL INTEGRATION ACTUALLY SLOWS

WHERE REGIONAL INTEGRATION ACTUALLY SLOWS · SUMMIT OUTPUTS ARE READ AS REGIONAL OBLIGATIONS · A DECLARATION, A VISION DOCUMENT, RULES OF PROCEDURE AND · AN AGREEMENT IN FORCE IS READ AS BINDING THE · BIMSTEC AGREEMENT ON MARITIME TRANSPORT COOPERATION SIGNED · 3 APRIL 2025; IN FORCE 18 MAY 2026 AMONG · VARIABLE-GEOMETRY RATIFICATION, NOT SUMMIT RELUCTANCE · IN FORCE FOR FOUR OF SEVEN IS THE ANSWER-GRABBING

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- PROBLEM → summit outputs are read as regional obligations
- RESPONSE → a declaration, a vision document, rules of procedure and an expert report are four evidentiary levels and none is a treaty obligation
- PROBLEM → an agreement in force is read as binding the whole region

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- RESPONSE: BIMSTEC Agreement on Maritime Transport Cooperation signed
- 3 April 2025; in force 18 May 2026 among Bhutan, India, Myanmar, Thailand after Myanmar deposited the fourth instrument on 13 May 2026
- DIAGNOSIS → variable-geometry ratification, not summit reluctance

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- RULE → in force for four of seven is the answer-grabbing formulation

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → in force for four of seven is the answer-grabbing formulation.

03 STAGE 03 — PARTICIPATION TIERS AND WHAT EACH ONE CONFERS

PARTICIPATION TIERS AND WHAT EACH ONE CONFERS · 8 MEMBERS · 7 MEMBERS · NO SEPARATE TIER RECORDED · 11 MEMBERS · DIALOGUE PARTNERS; INDIA FULL SINCE 1995 · TIMOR-LESTE ADMITTED AT THE 47TH ASEAN SUMMIT, 26 OCTOBER · 23 MEMBER STATES

SAARC — 8 members	observers
BIMSTEC → 7 members	no sojourn fee recorded
ASEAN → 11 members	dialogue partners: India full since 1995
IORA → 23 member states	12 dialogue partners
SCO → 10 members	2 observers, 15 dialogue partners
BRICS → 11 full members	10 partner countries, from 24 Oct 2024

ACTOR / INTEREST

- SAARC → 8 members
- BIMSTEC → 7 members
- no separate tier recorded
- ASEAN → 11 members
- dialogue partners; India full since 1995

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- IORA → 23 member states
- 12 dialogue partners
- SCO → 10 members
- 2 observers, 15 dialogue partners
- BRICS → 11 full members

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- G20 → 19 states + EU + AU
- guests and invited organisations
- OLVO → 4 participants
- non-treaty consultative miniateral
- RULE → tiers expand reach without expanding decision rights

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → tiers expand reach without expanding decision rights.

04 STAGE 04 — SOUTHEAST ASIAN ARCHITECTURE AND THE TRADE-AGREEMENT MAP

SOUTHEAST ASIAN ARCHITECTURE AND THE TRADE-AGREEMENT MAP · 22ND ASEAN-INDIA SUMMIT · KUALA LUMPUR, 26 OCTOBER 2025 · ASEAN-INDIA PLAN OF ACTION FOR THE COMPREHENSIVE STRATEGIC · PARTNERSHIP, 2026-2030 · AITIGA REVIEW · ONGOING, EXPRESSLY NOT CONCLUDED · ASEAN FTA PARTNERS

ASEAN FTA PARTNERS — China	South Korea	Japan	India
Australia-New Zealand	Hong Kong		

ACTOR / INTEREST

- 22nd ASEAN-INDIA SUMMIT → Kuala Lumpur, 26 October 2025
- FRAMEWORK → ASEAN-India Plan of Action for the Comprehensive Strategic
- Partnership, 2026-2030
- AITIGA REVIEW → ongoing, expressly not concluded

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- ASEAN FTA PARTNERS → China
- South Korea
- Australia-New Zealand
- Hong Kong

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- RCEP → ASEAN with Australia, China, Japan, South Korea, New Zealand
- INDIA IN RCEP → not a member
- TRAP → an ASEAN dialogue or trade partner is not thereby an ASEAN member

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: TRAP → an ASEAN dialogue or trade partner is not thereby an ASEAN member.

05 STAGE 05 — OCEANIC AND CONTINENTAL LAYERS WITH THEIR DATED OUTCOMES

OCEANIC AND CONTINENTAL LAYERS WITH THEIR DATED OUTCOMES · INDIAN OCEAN RIM ASSOCIATION, EARLIER IOR-ARC · SECRETARIAT AT EBENE, MAURITIUS; INDIA CHAIRS 2025-27, ASSUMED NOVEMBER · 24TH COUNCIL OF MINISTERS MET VIRTUALLY 21 MAY 2025 · CHARTER-BASED EURASIAN INTERGOVERNMENTAL ORGANISATION · INDIA A FULL MEMBER SINCE 2017; CHINA, RUSSIA, PAKISTAN · TIANJIN SUMMIT 31 AUGUST-1 SEPTEMBER 2025; TIANJIN DECLARATION · KYRGYZSTAN CHAIRS 2025-26 · IORA → Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier IOR-ARC

Secretariat at Ebene, Mauritius; India chairs 2025-27, assumed November 2025 → **24th Council of Ministers met virtually 21 May 2025; Colombo Communique cited by Tharoor as** → **SCO → charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation**

DATED OFFICIAL INSTRUMENT

- IORA → Indian Ocean Rim Association, earlier IOR-ARC
- Secretariat at Ebene, Mauritius; India chairs 2025-27, assumed November 2025
- 24th Council of Ministers met virtually 21 May 2025; Colombo Communique cited by Tharoor as a platform engaged alongside larger bodies

EVIDENTIARY LEVEL IT REACHES

- SCO → charter-based Eurasian intergovernmental organisation
- India a full member since 2017; China, Russia, Pakistan, Iran, Belarus inside
- Tianjin summit 31 August-1 September 2025; Tianjin Declaration

STATUS / CLAIM LIMIT

- Kyrgyzstan chairs 2025-26
- LIMIT → a seat supplies voice, never privileged access or shared threat views

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: LIMIT → a seat supplies voice, never privileged access or shared threat views.

06 STAGE 06 — GLOBAL-GOVERNANCE LAYER COUNTED CORRECTLY

GLOBAL-GOVERNANCE LAYER COUNTED CORRECTLY · 11 FULL MEMBERS; NOT A TREATY ALLIANCE PARTNER-COUNTRY CATEGORY · 17TH SUMMIT, RIO DE JANEIRO, 6-7 JULY 2025 · RIO DE JANEIRO DECLARATION · INDIA CHAIRSHIP 2026 LAUNCHED 13 JANUARY 2026 WITH THEME · NEW DEVELOPMENT BANK · 10 ACTUAL MEMBERS FIVE FOUNDERS + BANGLADESH 2021, UAE · UZBEKISTAN 2026; OTHER STATES LISTED AS PROSPECTIVE, NOT ACTUAL

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
BRICS — 11 full members; not a treaty alliance partner-country category of 10 created through the Kazan process, 24 Oct 2024	NEW DEVELOPMENT BANK — 10 actual members five founders + Bangladesh 2021, UAE 2021, Egypt 2023, Algeria 2025,	Johannesburg Summit 22-23 November 2025; United States holds 2026 presidency
17th Summit, Rio de Janeiro, 6-7 July 2025 — Rio de Janeiro Declaration	Uzbekistan 2026; other states listed as prospective, not actual	
India chairship 2026 launched 13 January 2026 with theme, logo and website no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome officially verified as of 3 August 2026	G20 — African Union a permanent member from 9 September 2023	

ACTOR / INTEREST

- BRICS → 11 full members; not a treaty alliance partner-country category of 10 created through the Kazan process, 24 Oct 2024
- 17th Summit, Rio de Janeiro, 6-7 July 2025 → Rio de Janeiro Declaration
- India chairship 2026 launched 13 January 2026 with theme, logo and website no 2026 Leaders' Summit outcome officially verified as of 3 August 2026

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- NEW DEVELOPMENT BANK → 10 actual members five founders + Bangladesh 2021, UAE 2021, Egypt 2023, Algeria 2025,
- Uzbekistan 2026; other states listed as prospective, not actual
- G20 → African Union a permanent member from 9 September 2023

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- Johannesburg Summit 22-23 November 2025; United States holds 2026 presidency

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Johannesburg Summit 22-23 November 2025; United States holds 2026 presidency.

07 STAGE 07 — MINILATERAL AGAINST TREATY ALLIANCE

MINILATERAL AGAINST TREATY ALLIANCE · INDIA, AUSTRALIA, JAPAN, UNITED STATES; NON-TREATY CONSULTATIVE · LEADERS' SUMMIT · WILMINGTON, DELAWARE, 21 SEPTEMBER 2024 · FOREIGN MINISTERS · NEW DELHI, 26 MAY 2026 · INDO-PACIFIC MARITIME SECURITY · COOPERATION INITIATIVE; INDO-PACIFIC ENERGY SECURITY INITIATIVE

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
QUAD → India, Australia, Japan, United States; non-treaty consultative	Critical Minerals Framework announced; Critical Minerals Initiative 1 July 2025	Norway, Portugal, United Kingdom, United States; ratified within five months
Leaders' Summit: Wilmington, Delaware, 21 September 2024	India announced as intended host; no held summit and no postponement verified	Article 5 invoked once ever, after 11 September 2001; confirmed 2 October 2001
Foreign Ministers: New Delhi, 26 May 2026 — Indo-Pacific Maritime Security	NATO — North Atlantic Treaty signed 4 April 1949, Washington, D.C., 12 states	Finland joined 2023; Sweden the 32nd member, March 2024; Council by consensus
Cooperation initiative: Indo-Pacific Energy Security Initiative	Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, Netherlands,	DECISIVE LINE — collective defence is a treaty obligation; the Quad has none

ACTOR / INTEREST

- QUAD → India, Australia, Japan, United States; non-treaty consultative
- Leaders' Summit: Wilmington, Delaware, 21 September 2024
- Foreign Ministers: New Delhi, 26 May 2026 — Indo-Pacific Maritime Security
- Cooperation initiative; Indo-Pacific Energy Security initiative

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- Critical Minerals Framework announced; Critical Minerals Initiative 1 July 2025
- India announced as intended host; no held summit and no postponement verified
- NATO — North Atlantic Treaty signed 4 April 1949, Washington, D.C., 12 states
- Belgium, Canada, Denmark, France, Iceland, Italy, Luxembourg, Netherlands,

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- Norway, Portugal, United Kingdom, United States; ratified within five months
- Article 5 invoked once ever, after 11 September 2001; confirmed 2 October 2001
- Finland joined 2023; Sweden the 32nd member, March 2024; Council by consensus
- DECISIVE LINE — collective defence is a treaty obligation; the Quad has none

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DECISIVE LINE — collective defence is a treaty obligation; the Quad has none.

08 STAGE 08 — HOW THE ALLIANCE REACHES INDIA WITHOUT INDIA BEING IN IT

HOW THE ALLIANCE REACHES INDIA WITHOUT INDIA BEING IN · RUSSIA CHANNEL · POST-2022 CONSOLIDATION DEEPENS RUSSIA-WEST CONFRONTATION · PRESSURE ON DEFENCE SPARES, ENERGY, PAYMENTS AND DIPLOMATIC BALANCING · EUROPE CHANNEL · FINLAND AND SWEDEN EXPAND NORTHERN GEOGRAPHY · STRONGER UNITED STATES-EUROPE COORDINATION, BUT ATTENTION AND DEFENCE INDUSTRIAL · TECHNOLOGY CHANNEL

RUSSIA CHANNEL — post-2022 consolidation deepens Russia-West confrontation → **pressure on defence spares, energy, payments and diplomatic balancing** → **EUROPE CHANNEL — Finland and Sweden expand northern geography** → **Stronger United States-Europe coordination, but attention and defence industrial capacity can shift toward Europe** → **TECHNOLOGY CHANNEL — tighter export-control and sanctions coordination**

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- RUSSIA CHANNEL → post-2022 consolidation deepens Russia-West confrontation
- pressure on defence spares, energy, payments and diplomatic balancing
- EUROPE CHANNEL → Finland and Sweden expand northern geography

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- stronger United States-Europe coordination, but attention and defence industrial capacity can shift toward Europe
- TECHNOLOGY CHANNEL → tighter export-control and sanctions coordination
- exposure for Indian firms and technology partnerships

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- INDIAN RESPONSE → diversify defence supply; deepen India-EU and bilateral
- European ties; keep issue-based Russia engagement; refuse alliance logic
- RULE → analyse transmission, not membership, when India is outside the body

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → analyse transmission, not membership, when India is outside the body.

09 STAGE 09 — TRILATERAL PLATFORMS AND THE SUBREGIONAL MECHANISM

TRILATERAL PLATFORMS AND THE SUBREGIONAL MECHANISM · INDIA, BRAZIL, SOUTH AFRICA; SIKKI · POTENTIALLY SIGNIFICANT · LEADERS' MEETING, JOHANNESBURG, 23 NOVEMBER 2025 DIGITAL INNOVATION ALLIANCE · PROPOSALS, EXPRESSLY NOT ESTABLISHED INSTITUTIONS · RUSSIA, INDIA, CHINA; ALSO NAMED BY SIKKI NO OFFICIALLY · MEETING OF 26 NOVEMBER 2021 · 6 MEMBERS

ACTOR / INTEREST	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	STATUS TRAP / LIMIT
IBSA → India, Brazil, South Africa; Sikki: potentially significant	RIC → Russia, India, China; also named by Sikki no officially verified meeting since the virtual 18th Foreign Ministers'	located officially; the 10th, Bangkok, 1 August 2019 corridor engineering routes to the neighbourhood owner
Leaders' Meeting, Johannesburg, 23 November 2025 digital innovation alliance and climate-resilient agriculture fund proposed	Meeting of 26 November 2021	DISCIPLINE → state the asymmetry whenever the platforms are listed together
STATUS → proposals, expressly not established institutions	MEKONG-GANGA → 6 members: Cambodia, India, Lao PDR, Myanmar, Thailand, Viet Nam most recent ministerial	

ACTOR / INTEREST

- IBSA → India, Brazil, South Africa; Sikki: potentially significant
- Leaders' Meeting, Johannesburg, 23 November 2025 digital innovation alliance and climate-resilient agriculture fund proposed
- STATUS → proposals, expressly not established institutions

DECISIVE DISTINCTION

- RIC → Russia, India, China; also named by Sikki no officially verified meeting since the virtual 18th Foreign Ministers'
- Meeting of 26 November 2021
- MEKONG-GANGA → 6 members: Cambodia, India, Lao PDR, Myanmar, Thailand, Viet Nam most recent ministerial

STATUS TRAP / LIMIT

- located officially; the 10th, Bangkok, 1 August 2019 corridor engineering routes to the neighbourhood owner
- DISCIPLINE → state the asymmetry whenever the platforms are listed together

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DISCIPLINE → state the asymmetry whenever the platforms are listed together.

10 STAGE 10 — REGIME VOCABULARY THAT DECIDES OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS

REGIME VOCABULARY THAT DECIDES OBJECTIVE QUESTIONS · INDIA THE 35TH MEMBER, 27 JUNE 2016 VOLUNTARY EXPORT-CONTROL · INDIA NOT A MEMBER; APPLICATION DISTINCT FROM THE 2008 · INDIA A FOUNDING MEMBER AND THE SECOND-LARGEST SHAREHOLDER AFTER · INDIA A FULL MEMBER SINCE 2017; ACCESS WITHOUT SHARED · IAEA ADDITIONAL PROTOCOL · IN FORCE 25 JULY 2014; APPLIES TO SAFEGUARDS ONLY · ASEM JOINED 2007; APEC STILL A NON-MEMBERSHIP EXAMPLE, 3 · MTCR → India the 35th member, 27 June 2016 voluntary export-control arrangement; rule access, not

NSG → India not a member; application distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil → **AIIB → India a founding member and the second-largest shareholder after China finance access and** → **SCO → India a full member since 2017; access without shared threat perception**

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- MTCR → India the 35th member, 27 June 2016 voluntary export-control arrangement; rule access, not guaranteed transfer
- NSG → India not a member; application distinct from the 2008 India-specific waiver enabling civil nuclear commerce; admission needs consensus

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- AIIB → India a founding member and the second-largest shareholder after China finance access and a governance stake, never unilateral control
- SCO → India a full member since 2017; access without shared threat perception

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- IAEA ADDITIONAL PROTOCOL → in force 25 July 2014; applies to safeguards only it does not make India a non-nuclear-weapon State under the NPT
- GAP → ASEM joined 2007; APEC still a non-membership example, 3 August 2026

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: MTCR → India the 35th member, 27 June 2016 voluntary export-control arrangement; rule access, not guaranteed transfer.

11 STAGE 11 — ANSWER SPINE FOR A GROUPINGS OR MINILATERALISM DEMAND

ANSWER SPINE FOR A GROUPINGS OR MINILATERALISM DEMAND · NAME THE LAYER, THE LEGAL FORM AND THE EXACT · ONE DATED INSTRUMENT WITH ITS PRECISE EVIDENTIARY LEVEL ATTACHED · TREATY-BOUND CHARTER BODY AGAINST NON-TREATY COALITION, BOTH NAMED · SEPARATE ANNOUNCED, SIGNED, IN FORCE AND IN FORCE FOR · BANDWIDTH COST, EFFECTIVENESS VARIANCE, COHERENCE DILUTION · THE 2020 QUAD, 2021 AND 2023 SCO, 2022 BIMSTEC-SAARC · FORM MUST MATCH THE PROBLEM; MULTIPLYING MEMBERSHIPS WITHOUT DELIVERY

OPEN → name the layer, the legal form and the exact participation tier → **EVIDENCE → one dated instrument with its precise evidentiary level attached** → **COMPARE → treaty-bound charter body against non-treaty coalition, both named** → **TEST → separate announced, signed, in force and in force for how many members** → **CONCEDE → bandwidth cost, effectiveness variance, coherence dilution**

INTEREST / DOCTRINE

- OPEN → name the layer, the legal form and the exact participation tier
- EVIDENCE → one dated instrument with its precise evidentiary level attached
- COMPARE → treaty-bound charter body against non-treaty coalition, both named

DIPLOMATIC MECHANISM

- TEST → separate announced, signed, in force and in force for how many members
- CONCEDE → bandwidth cost, effectiveness variance, coherence dilution
- OWNERSHIP → the 2020 Quad, 2021 and 2023 SCO, 2022 BIMSTEC-SAARC, 2022 IZUZ and 2023 alliance-expansion demands are the routed Mains questions

CONSTRAINT / TRADE-OFF

- CLOSE → form must match the problem; multiplying memberships without delivery or status precision produces only diplomatic symbolism

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE → form must match the problem; multiplying memberships without delivery or status precision produces only diplomatic symbolism.

E EXTRA — SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · BIMSTEC CHARTER (IN FORCE 20 MAY 2024) AND THE · BRICS RIO DE JANEIRO DECLARATION (17TH SUMMIT, 6-7 JULY · IBSA AND RIC · TRILATERAL PLATFORMS WHOSE "POTENTIALLY SIGNIFICANT" · MOST RECENT LEADERS' SUMMIT AT WILMINGTON, 21 SEPTEMBER 2024 · FULL INSTITUTIONAL/CONNECTIVITY PROFILE RESERVED FOR TOPIC 05. · FULL MARITIME-SECURITY INSTITUTIONAL PROFILE RESERVED FOR TOPIC

OPTIONAL DOCTRINE AND INSTRUMENT DEPTH

- BIMSTEC Charter (in force 20 May 2024) and the 6th Summit (Bangkok,
- BRICS Rio de Janeiro Declaration (17th Summit, 6-7 July 2025): the
- IBSA and RIC: trilateral platforms whose "potentially significant"
- Quad: most recent Leaders' Summit at Wilmington, 21 September 2024.

STATUS, DATE AND FIGURE LIMIT

- CAUTION: SCO: full institutional/connectivity profile reserved for topic 05.
- CAUTION: Quad: full maritime-security institutional profile reserved for topic
- CAUTION: Boundary case — SAARC stagnation vs. BIMSTEC ascendance: the shift in
- CAUTION: Boundary case — SCO membership without privileged access: as in topic

COMPARATIVE DIPLOMATIC NUANCE

- CAUTION: Boundary case — membership gaps as a corrective to triumphalist
- CAUTION: Boundary case — BRICS expansion and coherence trade-off: BRICS's
- CAUTION: Overlap has real coordination costs: engaging five distinct layers of
- CAUTION: Institutional-effectiveness variance is a genuine limitation: a

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels